SHE POWER RISING

Namita Thapar, the executive director of Emcure Pharmaceuticals who has become a household name after her stint in *Shark Tank India*, remembers the time when a banker chose to respond to her father—Emcure founder Satish Mehta—even as she was the one who had posed a question. Avarna Jain of Saregama had a similar story to share, that of a friend who was told to "bring along the decision-maker" after a recent meeting.

According to Namita, the "new breed" of women entrepreneurs is changing such mindsets. Anu Ranjan, president, The Indian Television Academy, agrees. "Wherever we are, we are doing fabulously. More women should be encouraged to come forward, as we think very clearly," she said.

The three women leaders came together at the India Today Conclave, highlighting the challenges women face in their respective industries while also acknowledging the progress made and areas that still need improvement. The session also focused on the role television plays in challenging stereotypes, addressing unspoken issues, and empowering women to move beyond traditional roles. "Television has been and will always remain relevant. OTTs are mostly paid platforms and are still inaccessible to most of the people in the country," noted Anu. ■

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **Women leaders keep facing biases, highlighting the need for deeper cultural change**
- **Safety concerns keep many women away from field jobs even as their participation in creative and other spheres is rising**

> **I've used my voice to bust taboos and educate people on uncomfortable topics related to women's health**
>
> **–Namita Thapar**
> *Executive Director, Emcure Pharmaceuticals Ltd*

> **At our company, the pay has nothing to do with if you're a woman or a man. It's about your ability, capability, position**
>
> **- Avarna Jain**
> *Vice Chairperson, Saregama*

> **Women today are in every sphere and should encourage other women to come forward**
>
> **-Anu Ranjan**
> *President, The Indian Television Academy*

Photographs by **BANDEEP SINGH**

